

3.4

Difficult questions

- A** Interviewers need to see evidence of the following skills and personal qualities.

Business skills	Ability to make money Ability to save money Ability to save time Ability to follow procedures
Professional skills	Honesty Pride in your work Ability to work in teams Analytical skills Reliability (you can be trusted)
Personal qualities	Communication skills Listening skills Self-confidence Motivation and determination Friendliness and openness Right for the department Right for the company image

- Which ones will be clear from your CV/Resume?
- Why do interviewers ask difficult questions?

- B** Look at these typical 'difficult questions'. Discuss how you would answer them.

- 1 Perhaps you'd like to start by telling us a little bit about yourself?
- 2 So what have you learnt from your previous jobs?
- 3 What would you say are your strong points?
- 4 And your weak points?
- 5 Can you work under pressure – time pressure for example?
- 6 How do you take direction and criticism?
- 7 It sounds like you enjoy your work. Why do you want to leave your current job?
- 8 So what sort of challenges are you looking for?
- 9 And what are your career objectives?
- 10 Are you willing to go where the company sends you?

- C** Match the possible responses a–j below with the ten questions from section B.

- a 'Maybe I am a little too perfectionist'. 'Perhaps I worry too much about deadlines.' These could be considered strong points.
- b Your current job doesn't allow you to grow professionally and you want more challenges. Also, be honest about practical things like distance from your home, job security etc.
- c Don't talk too much. Cover your origins, education and work experience. Then make a bridge to why you are there.
- d You want to grow and develop, and you want more responsibility. Give some examples: learning new skills, experience of different areas, being in charge of projects etc.
- e You have learned the importance of teamwork and of listening to other people's advice. You have also developed a good business sense: everything has to be justified in terms of cost.
- f You welcome it and listen carefully. It is necessary in order to learn and develop.
- g Give two or three points like honesty, working well in a team and determination. Say a few words about each one to make your comments personal and sincere.
- h Yes, you find it stimulating. However, you believe in planning and good time management to reduce last-minute panic.
- i Answer 'yes' immediately. Then ask how much travel is involved in the job. You can always not take the job later if you change your mind.
- j Say what kind of job you would like about three years from now, and why.

- D** Work with a partner. Ask and answer the questions in section B.

